

A STRATEGY GAME SETTING / ORIGINAL FICTION

MERIDIAN FRACTURE

Working setting and faction bible

8 factions / 24 subfactions / 48 unique units

The year is 2086. The Meridian Network once linked regional power grids, freight routing, desalination controls and disaster forecasting. It did not create energy: it made a fragile, unequal world depend on coordinated delivery. During the Long Blackout of 2057, cascading technical failures and competing emergency shutdowns broke that coordination. No faction can prove whether the first failure was sabotage, negligence or an attempt to prevent something worse.

Over three decades, reconstruction commands hardened into eight rival blocs. Meridian's surviving regional control vaults can now reconnect major industrial corridors. Whoever governs those connections can restore livelihoods, ration access or shut rivals out. The war is fought for substations, ports, salvage fields, manufacturing cities and the right to decide who gets power first.

Each faction offers a credible public good and an institutional danger. None is a stand-in for the moral character of a present-day country, religion or population. National names identify fictional successor commands; their military doctrines come from reconstruction history. All names and technology below are proposals, not canon that the game must retain.

From shared infrastructure to contested sovereignty

Year	Turning point	Result
2039-2056	Meridian construction	A patchwork of national projects becomes an interdependent energy and logistics system.
2057	The Long Blackout	Nine months of cascading regional failures trigger evacuations, rationing and emergency rule.
2058-2074	The reconstruction wars	Convoy services, local governments and surviving militaries form new political alliances.
2075-2085	The corridor settlement	Eight blocs negotiate temporary transit rights while rebuilding military industry.
2086	The failed restart	A disputed restart at Meridian Vault Nine cuts power to several neutral cities. Every bloc mobilizes; the responsible decision remains contested.

Reading this bible

Pages 2-5 define common rules and compare the factions. Each faction then has two vanilla reference pages followed by one complete page for each subfaction. The final pages describe campaign conflicts and balance priorities.

Version 0.1 / 29 September 2026. The title, institutions and technology are proposals. All numerical values are starting points for playtesting.

01 / DESIGN FRAMEWORK

The rules behind the rosters

Roster selection. Choose one of 32 playable rosters before the match: 8 vanilla factions or one of their 24 subfactions. A subfaction inherits its parent faction's traits, structures, service units, two shared upgrades, two shared powers and superweapon. It replaces exactly two combat units, loses one additional combat unit, gains one exclusive upgrade, and replaces the vanilla-only third power with its own. You cannot mix subfaction packages.

Economy. One spendable resource: credits, earned by Collectors delivering salvage from designated deposits to Refineries. Power is a separate capacity budget, not currency. No faction needs a second harvest resource. Suggested starting preset: one deployed HQ and 7,500 credits; medium game speed; no veterancy in the first balance prototype.

Technology. T1 is the opening roster. Radar unlocks T2. Radar plus Laboratory unlock T3. A unit always needs its listed producer as well. No faction needs a Dock to unlock land or air technology; every roster is playable on a land-only map.

Production. Each Barracks, Factory, Airfield and Dock has one independent queue. Research uses one player-wide queue. Building construction uses one player-wide queue. Additional production structures add queues, not hidden speed bonuses. A replaced unit cannot also be built.

Research. Upgrades cost the listed credits and take 45 seconds at T2 or 75 seconds at T3. T2 research requires an intact Radar; T3 research requires Radar and Laboratory. Completed upgrades persist if those buildings are lost. Losing a tech prerequisite pauses dependent unfinished unit and research orders until rebuilt.

Power loss. During a shortage, normal production and research progress at 50% speed; powered defenses and Relay bonuses stop. Powered Radar/Laboratory support powers cannot activate. Superweapon recharge pauses. Existing units and completed upgrades continue to work. SAP defense reserves are the stated exception, not a second resource.

Scope of modifiers. Combat-unit modifiers apply to the listed combat roster, including its support specialists, but not the four shared service units unless explicitly stated. Structure modifiers apply only to the named structure class. Transport bonuses include any unit explicitly tagged Transport. Units retain role tags when replaced unless the replacement explicitly changes role.

How percentages combine. Apply three layers: base specification, then parent-faction modifiers, then subfaction modifiers, then research/temporary effects. Within a layer, changes to the same stat add; layers multiply. Example: parent vehicle health +10% and subfaction vehicle health -10% yield $1.10 \times 0.90 = 0.99$ of the base health. Bonuses with identical sources never stack.

Caps and interpretation. Final purchase cost and build time cannot fall below 60% of the base specification. Final reload interval cannot fall below 50%. Combined damage resistance cannot reduce incoming weapon damage by more than 50%, except a successful projectile interception which removes that projectile. Build time -20% means 0.80 times the duration; it is not the same as production progressing 20% faster.

Prototype boundary. The percentages, power prices and timings are initial tuning targets. The bible defines roles and prerequisites, not final weapon damage, armor tables, model counts, pathfinding or unit prices. Each unique unit needs its own base stat specification; replacing a unit does not imply identical stats.

02 / BUILDING AND SERVICE TECHNOLOGY

Shared infrastructure

HQ > Generator > Refinery > Factory > Radar > Laboratory

Generator also unlocks Barracks; Refinery unlocks Dock; Radar unlocks Airfield. Laboratory and Radar unlock the advanced defense and superweapon. A Dock is never required for land or air progression.

Structure	Requires	Credits	Power	Function / build time
Headquarters	Starting MCV, or deploy a new MCV	0	0	Construction anchor; 8-cell build radius. A deployed starting HQ is free.
Generator	Headquarters	600	150	Provides power; construction 25 s.
Refinery	Generator	1800	-30	Includes one Collector on completion; 40 s.
Barracks	Generator	500	-10	Produces infantry and Engineers; 20 s.
Factory	Refinery	2000	-40	Produces land vehicles and MCVs; 40 s.
Dock	Refinery + valid shoreline	1800	-35	Produces ships and Landing Transports; 40 s.
Radar	Factory	1500	-40	Unlocks T2, Airfield and first powers; 30 s.
Airfield	Radar	1600	-40	Produces and services aircraft; four pads; 35 s.
Laboratory	Radar	2500	-60	Unlocks T3, advanced defenses and superweapon; 50 s.
Faction superweapon	Radar + Laboratory	5000	-200	One per player; construction 90 s; recharge listed by faction.
Watchtower	Barracks	450	-5	Anti-infantry; detector radius 4; 15 s.
Anti-tank turret	Factory	800	-15	Direct-fire anti-vehicle defense; 20 s.
AA battery	Radar	900	-20	Anti-air defense; detector radius 5; 20 s.
Faction advanced defense	Radar + Laboratory	1800	-40	Faction-specific role; 35 s.

Service units present in every roster

Engineer - Barracks; T1; 500 credits. Captures neutral tech structures and repairs friendly land vehicles or structures. No weapon. Baseline repair rate 1% target maximum health/s, costing 0.5% of the target's paid price/s. Enemy production and superweapons are not capturable in this prototype.

Collector - Refinery; T1; 1,400 credits. One supplied by each completed Refinery; additional Collectors can be purchased. Harvest and unload rules are identical for all rosters unless explicitly changed.

Mobile Construction Vehicle - Factory + Radar; T2; 3,000 credits. Deploys into a Headquarters to establish another construction area. Slow, unarmed and expensive; no free deployment income.

Landing Transport - Dock; T1; 900 credits. Unarmed amphibious service transport. Carries four infantry squads or two non-amphibious land vehicles, but never another transport or an MCV. Provides a water-crossing option to every roster.

03 / SHARED MECHANICS

Combat and strategic rules

Support-power access. Each roster has exactly three support powers: two inherited powers and one vanilla-only or subfaction-specific power. T2 powers require a powered Radar; T3 powers require powered Radar and Laboratory. Powers cost credits per use, have separate cooldowns in seconds, and are ready when first unlocked. Rebuilding a prerequisite never resets a cooldown.

Targeting and warnings. Reconnaissance powers may target any map location. Other support powers need current vision unless their text explicitly supplies reconnaissance. Superweapons may target previously explored terrain without current vision. Strategic warning zones are visible to affected players and cannot be hidden by fog or decoys.

Superweapon control. A strategic structure starts empty and charges only with enough power and intact Radar/Laboratory. One charge may be stored; no stockpiling. The full recharge starts at activation. Destruction or EMP shutdown of the launcher during its warning cancels the attack without refunding the charge; an ordinary power shortage after activation does not cancel it. Ordinary AA cannot intercept strategic attacks except the explicitly shootable Tempest drones.

Damage and area notation. One cell means one ordinary terrain tile. A radius is measured from the marked center; all times are real-time seconds at normal speed. Damage-bearing area attacks can hurt friendlies. Aurora affects enemies only; summoned attackers select enemies only. Support buffs affect friendlies unless the text explicitly says otherwise.

Interception and strategic packets. For Trident, each Atlas rod, Perun core/ring blast, Horizon impact, Tempest drone hit and Dragonfall engine shot is one impact packet. Eight charges reduce one packet by 50%. Fewer than eight cannot reduce it. Helios and Aurora bypass Trident as beam and EMP effects. All reductions still obey the overall 50% resistance cap.

Concealment and electronic warfare. Camouflaged units are revealed within 5 cells of a detector unless a different radius is listed. Firing, taking damage or the specific ability's movement restriction also reveals them. Detector vehicles, every T2 escort and basic Watchtowers prevent concealment from becoming an uncounterable opening. EMP never changes ownership and never instantly kills an aircraft.

Suppression, cover and smoke. Suppression triggers after three designated suppressive hits within 2 seconds, reducing infantry movement by 25% for 3 seconds after the last hit. Fortress Guard fire and Watchtower fire are suppressive; other weapons are not unless later specified. Portable cover takes 4 seconds, lasts 45 seconds, allows one piece per builder and provides 20% bullet resistance unless stated otherwise. Marked civilian garrisons hold four infantry squads. Smoke uses the two-sided Dust Screen rule.

Transports, aircraft and repairs. Combat transports normally carry two infantry squads and cannot shoot with their passengers' weapons. Okapi carries three squads and Leviathan four; Kancil, Beaver, Naga and other APCs carry two. Aircraft need powered Airfield pads to rearm; carriers replenish only their own drones. Heal and repair auras from the same source do not stack. Field repair stations cannot repair themselves.

Role tags. Light means APC/scout chassis plus Sandglass, Scorpion and Reed artillery. Tank means direct-fire armored land combat units, including siege tanks, Ifrit, Kiln and Gaj, but not Dragon/Long command walkers or Leviathan transports. Artillery means indirect ground launchers, not direct-fire siege tanks, ships or aircraft. Unmanned means Firefly, Nest/Reed, Swallow, Silkwing, Nightjar and carrier-launched drones; not crewed carriers or temporary superweapon units.

Submarines and wrecks. Boreal Missile Submarines camouflage underwater and surface for 8 seconds when firing. Detectors reveal them; only anti-submarine weapons can target them underwater, while strategic blast damage still applies. Enemy land combat-vehicle wrecks persist for 60 seconds unless destroyed or salvaged; only the African Empire can turn them into credits. No salvage from friendly fire, deliberate scuttling or summons.

04 / EIGHT FACTIONS, THIRTY-TWO ROSTERS

Choose your doctrine

Faction	Vanilla doctrine	Subfaction directions
North American Peace Corps	Durable combined arms; reliable frontline vehicles and recovery.	USA: Sustained air operations and precision strikes / Canada: Amphibious armor and protected transport; useful on rivers and ordinary land / Mexico: Affordable assault infantry with strong urban pressure
New European Confederation	Precision, sensor networks and deliberate positional warfare.	Nordics: Reconnaissance, mobile missiles and coastal denial / Eurocorps: Expensive armored formations and siege breakthroughs / Alpine Brotherhood: Fortified infantry, compact artillery positions and repairable defenses
Order of the Levant and Mediterranean	Mobile combined arms, concealment and abundant electrical power.	Saudi Arabia: Energy weapons and power-efficient late-game positions / Algeria: Fast light vehicles, ambushes and harassment / El-Andalus: Port defense, durable escorts and infantry holding power
Democratic Eurasian Federation	Industrial volume, artillery saturation and replaceable armored forces.	Russia: Slow armored assaults with active protection / Kazakhstan: Fast reconnaissance and mobile missile warfare / North Korea: Durable infantry, prepared positions and decoys
Pacific Dominion	Amphibious maneuver, naval reach and flexible coastal logistics.	Australia: Long-range expeditionary artillery backed by reconnaissance aircraft / Indonesia: Transport assaults, inexpensive marines and raids across several routes / Japan: Expensive precision systems, adaptable armor and advanced carriers
Han Empire	Affordable infantry, unmanned support and vulnerable command links.	China: Heavy armor and stronger local command coverage / Vietnam: Concealed infantry and amphibious rocket raids / Cambodia: Drone sustain, field repair and economical support systems
African Empire	Recovery, battlefield salvage and practical industrial endurance.	Nigeria: Fast mobilization, infantry presence and protective drone support / Kongo: Amphibious transport, durable infantry and concealed recovery teams / South Africa: Long-range ground weapons and expensive precision vehicles
South Asian Protectorate	Protected advances, resilient defenses and battlefield engineering.	India: Heavy protected pushes supported by economical power infrastructure / Thailand: Amphibious infantry assaults and mobile defense / Pakistan: Long-range missile artillery and concealed forward observation

How the technology pages work

B = Barracks; F = Factory; A = Airfield; D = Dock. T1 needs its producer; T2 needs its producer and Radar; T3 needs its producer, Radar and Laboratory. Every subfaction page lists its entire resolved combat roster, plus its unique research and third support power.

Vanilla keeps the widest roster and its own coordination power. Specialization is a trade: each subfaction replaces two units and removes a third. New units inherit applicable role-based upgrades, but never silently keep the replaced unit's special ability.

01 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

North American Peace Corps

Hold the line. Bring them home.

After the Long Blackout, North American evacuation commands became the only institutions able to keep continental supply routes open. Their emergency charter hardened into the North American Peace Corps, a military reconstruction alliance rather than the historical civilian organization. Its elected Assembly promises to reopen the Meridian Network under public supervision. Generals argue that the network must first be secured by force. Communities grateful for restored power increasingly question why temporary military administrations never leave.

Visual direction. Olive, cream and rescue orange; broad hulls, modular armor, visible crew cabins.

Land combat vehicles: health +10%, purchase cost +10%.

Factory service apron: friendly land combat vehicles within 5 cells recover 1% maximum health per second, up to 75%, after 6 seconds without dealing or taking damage. Multiple aprons do not stack.

Strengths: dependable armor, repair efficiency, clear combined-arms roles. Weaknesses: expensive vehicle losses and limited concealment.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Rifle Squad	B / T1	General infantry; good against infantry, weak against armor.
Javelin Team	B / T1	Stationary-firing anti-tank missiles; vulnerable while repositioning.
Combat Medic	B / T2	Unarmed infantry healer; cannot repair vehicles.
Pathfinder APC	F / T1	Light transport, scout and detector; loses to tanks.
Guardian Tank	F / T1	Conventional medium tank; main frontline unit.
Sentinel AA	F / T2	Dedicated mobile anti-air and detector; poor ground weapon.
Paladin Howitzer	F / T2	Indirect siege artillery; must deploy for 3 seconds.
Bastion Heavy Tank	F / T3	Slow twin-gun breakthrough tank; easily outmaneuvered.
Falcon Interceptor	A / T2	Air-superiority fighter; no ground attack.
Titan Gunship	A / T3	Armored hovering anti-vehicle aircraft; vulnerable to concentrated AA.
Riverwatch Patrol Boat	D / T1	Cheap anti-infantry and light-surface patrol craft.
Aegis Frigate	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Liberty Arsenal Ship	D / T3	Long-range land bombardment; depends on escorts.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

01 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

NAPC / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Bulwark Cannon and Atlas Kinetic Array

Advanced defense: Bulwark Cannon. Long-range anti-vehicle cannon; slow traverse and poor infantry damage.

Shared upgrades

Adaptive Plating - T2 | 1,000 credits

Land combat vehicles take 10% less explosive damage. Does not reduce beam, rail or bullet damage.

Joint Tactical Links - T3 | 1,600 credits

Sentinel AA and Aegis Frigates gain weapon range +10% while within 6 cells of a friendly Rifle Squad, Javelin Team or their replacements.

Support powers

UAV Sweep - T2 | 500 credits | 90 s cooldown

A shootable reconnaissance UAV circles a 7-cell-radius area for 12 seconds, revealing terrain and detecting concealed units.

Field Repair Drop - T3 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown

A shootable cargo aircraft delivers a repair station. It repairs friendly land vehicles in 5 cells by 2% maximum health per second for 10 seconds; stations do not stack.

Vanilla only: Combined Arms Window - T2 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown

For 15 seconds, friendly infantry, land vehicles and aircraft in a selected 6-cell-radius zone deal 10% more weapon damage. Ships and structures receive no bonus.

Superweapon / Atlas Kinetic Array

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 8 min recharge | 10 s warning

A surviving orbital magazine releases three guided kinetic penetrators at a selected point and two points 3 cells to either side. Each has a 2-cell damage radius. It is strongest against clustered heavy vehicles and key buildings; the gaps and long warning reward dispersal.

Counterplay. Move valuable units between the impact circles, spread essential buildings, or destroy the control structure before the warning expires.

On the battlefield

Opening. Rifle Squad and Pathfinder scout first; two Guardians secure the first expansion. Add Sentinel AA before committing to Paladins. Preserve damaged vehicles instead of trading them.

Fight this faction. Raid collectors while the main army repairs, attack from several directions, and use cheaper anti-tank units to punish heavy-vehicle concentration.

01.1 / NAPC SUBFACTION

USA / Air Mobility Command

The continental airlift service rebuilt scattered cities long before roads reopened. Its commanders believe control of the sky is the only humane way to shorten a war; critics see a doctrine that can leave occupied territory without enough troops to hold it.

Doctrine. Sustained air operations and precision strikes.

Modifiers. Aircraft cost -15%. Aircraft rearm time -20%. Land combat vehicle build time +15%.

Unique units and losses

Raptor Multirole Fighter (A / T2) replaces Falcon Interceptor. Switches between anti-air and anti-vehicle missile loads at an Airfield. Cannot carry both; less effective in air combat than a dedicated Falcon.

Condor Stealth Bomber (A / T3) replaces Titan Gunship. Camouflages after 6 seconds without attacking. One heavy anti-structure bomb per sortie; slow rearm and weak protection when detected.

Removed without replacement. Bastion Heavy Tank.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Rifle Squad; Javelin Team	Pathfinder APC; Guardian Tank	-	Riverwatch Patrol Boat
T2	Combat Medic	Sentinel AA; Paladin Howitzer	Raptor Multirole Fighter	Aegis Frigate
T3	-	-	Condor Stealth Bomber	Liberty Arsenal Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Bulwark Cannon and Atlas Kinetic Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Adaptive Plating (T2); Joint Tactical Links (T3).

Exclusive research: Dispersed Runways. T2 | 1,100 credits. Airfields gain two extra service pads; service rate per pad is unchanged.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. UAV Sweep (T2); Field Repair Drop (T3).

New third power: Rapid Turnaround. T2 | 700 credits | 150 s cooldown. One powered Airfield rearms aircraft 50% faster for 20 seconds. Does not accelerate aircraft production.

Replaces vanilla-only Combined Arms Window. Superweapon: Atlas is unchanged. Use air reconnaissance to find high-value, tightly packed targets. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Build a normal infantry and Guardian screen, then an early Airfield. Mix Raptor loadouts and attack exposed production with Condors.

Counterplay. Layer AA with detectors, pressure Airfields, and advance during bomber rearm windows.

01.2 / NAPC SUBFACTION

Canada / Northern Littoral Command

Northern ports and lake routes became the continent's winter lifelines. Littoral Command developed sealed vehicles and floating depots for routes that alternated between water, mud and broken pavement. It favors patient advances that keep evacuation routes open.

Doctrine. Amphibious armor and protected transport; useful on rivers and ordinary land.

Modifiers. Amphibious combat units gain health +10% on all terrain. Ship build time -15%. Amphibious vehicle movement speed on water +20%. Land artillery reload interval +15%.

Unique units and losses

Beaver Amphibious APC (F / T1) replaces Pathfinder APC. Detector and infantry transport that crosses water; reinforced passenger protection, but a weak weapon.

Narwhal Amphibious Tank (F / T2) replaces Guardian Tank. Medium cannon tank that crosses water. Slower and less heavily armed than a Guardian; requires Radar.

Removed without replacement. Titan Gunship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Rifle Squad; Javelin Team	Beaver Amphibious APC	-	Riverwatch Patrol Boat
T2	Combat Medic	Narwhal Amphibious Tank; Sentinel AA; Paladin Howitzer	Falcon Interceptor	Aegis Frigate
T3	-	Bastion Heavy Tank	-	Liberty Arsenal Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Bulwark Cannon and Atlas Kinetic Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Adaptive Plating (T2); Joint Tactical Links (T3).

Exclusive research: Sealed Compartments. T2 | 1,000 credits. Beaver and Narwhal units take 15% less explosive damage while on water.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. UAV Sweep (T2); Field Repair Drop (T3).

New third power: Floating Workshop. T2 | 800 credits | 180 s cooldown. Deploy a visible repair pontoon on clear land or water. For 20 seconds it repairs friendly vehicles and ships within 5 cells at 1.5% maximum health per second.

Replaces vanilla-only Combined Arms Window. Superweapon: Atlas is unchanged. Amphibious scouts enable attacks behind a coastal defense line. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use infantry and Beavers until Radar unlocks Narwhals; attack across secondary routes while frigates protect the crossing.

Counterplay. Pressure before Radar, cover exits from water, and use air attacks against the slower siege component.

01.3 / NAPC SUBFACTION

Mexico / Federal Vanguard

Mexican reconstruction brigades cleared rail junctions and defended dense resettlement districts. Their veterans formed the Federal Vanguard, demanding that the Corps protect inhabited places rather than merely draw secure borders around them. Their political leverage rests on citizen soldiers who expect to go home.

Doctrine. Affordable assault infantry with strong urban pressure.

Modifiers. Combat infantry cost -15%. Combat infantry build time -20%. Aircraft cost +20%.

Unique units and losses

Vanguard Rifle Squad (B / T1) replaces Rifle Squad. May deploy portable cover in 4 seconds. Gains 20% bullet-damage resistance while stationary behind it; packing takes 2 seconds.

Aguila Breach Team (B / T2) replaces Combat Medic. Armored assault infantry with anti-building charges and a short-range grenade launcher. Cannot heal; vulnerable in open ground.

Removed without replacement. Liberty Arsenal Ship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Vanguard Rifle Squad; Javelin Team	Pathfinder APC; Guardian Tank	-	Riverwatch Patrol Boat
T2	Aguila Breach Team	Sentinel AA; Paladin Howitzer	Falcon Interceptor	Aegis Frigate
T3	-	Bastion Heavy Tank	Titan Gunship	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Bulwark Cannon and Atlas Kinetic Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Adaptive Plating (T2); Joint Tactical Links (T3).

Exclusive research: Section Logistics. T2 | 1,000 credits. Combat infantry recover 1% maximum health per second near a powered Barracks after 6 seconds out of combat.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. UAV Sweep (T2); Field Repair Drop (T3).

New third power: Coordinated Advance. T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown. Friendly infantry in a 6-cell-radius zone gain movement speed +25% and suppression immunity for 12 seconds. Existing suppression is removed.

Replaces vanilla-only Combined Arms Window. Superweapon: Atlas is unchanged. Use it to break fortified positions that infantry cannot safely approach. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Contest capture points with Vanguard squads; use Guardians and Javelins to protect Aguila teams approaching buildings.

Counterplay. Use conventional area damage, mobile machine-gun vehicles and repeated flanking moves; deny safe rally points.

02 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

New European Confederation

No city stands alone.

The old continental institutions failed when member governments seized their own power reserves. City leagues, surviving national services and industrial cooperatives later negotiated a new confederation with narrow but enforceable obligations. Its armies defend a dense lattice of shared sensors and guaranteed supply routes. The Confederation wants Meridian governed by treaty and transparent technical standards, yet its smaller members fear that the engineers who define those standards will quietly become the new rulers.

Visual direction. Slate blue, white and amber; low profiles, angular turrets, fold-out sensor masts.

Networked fire: friendly combat infantry and land combat vehicles within 6 cells of a powered friendly Relay deal weapon damage +10%. Relay fields do not stack.

All combat units cost +5%; service units are exempt.

Strengths: precise fire, strong defensive positions and efficient local coordination. Weaknesses: costly units and dependence on vulnerable Relay coverage.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Jager Squad	B / T1	Accurate general infantry; vulnerable to area damage.
Spike Team	B / T1	Long-range guided anti-tank infantry; must stop to fire.
Sapper	B / T2	Combat engineer with a short-range weapon and temporary infantry cover; cannot replace the service Engineer.
Surveyor APC	F / T1	Fast scout, detector and light infantry transport.
Leopard Tank	F / T1	Well-balanced medium tank; limited splash damage.
Rapier AA	F / T2	Long-range mobile anti-air and detector.
Archer SPG	F / T2	Accurate indirect artillery; fragile and slow to deploy.
Argent Rail Tank	F / T3	Long-range armor killer; slow reload, weak against infantry.
Kestrel Interceptor	A / T2	Dedicated fighter with a short rearm cycle.
Aster EW Aircraft	A / T3	Unarmed jammer: enemies within 5 cells have sight -25%; no effect on weapon range or fixed detection radius.
Skerry Patrol Boat	D / T1	Fast surface scout with a light autocannon.
Horizon Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Concord Monitor	D / T3	Precision coastal artillery ship; vulnerable to close attack.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

02 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

NEC / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Lance Rail Emplacement and Aurora Microwave Array; Radar -> Relay

Advanced defense: Lance Rail Emplacement. Very long-range single-target anti-armor defense; minimal splash and a long reload.

Additional structure: Relay. T2; 600 credits. Requires Radar; consumes 20 power. Provides the 6-cell networked-fire zone. It must be placed in normal construction range and does not extend that range.

Shared upgrades

Sensor Fusion - T2 | 1,100 credits

Surveyor APC, Rapier AA and Horizon Escort detection radius +2 cells; replacements inherit it.

Distributed Control - T3 | 1,700 credits

Relay radius increases from 6 to 8 cells. A Relay retains its damage-bonus field for 10 seconds after losing power, but not after destruction.

Support powers

Survey Drone - T2 | 450 credits | 90 s cooldown

A shootable drone reveals and detects within 6 cells of the target for 15 seconds.

Counterbattery Mission - T3 | 1,100 credits | 180 s cooldown

After 5 seconds of warning, six conventional precision shells strike a selected 4-cell-radius area over 4 seconds. Moderate siege damage; moving units can escape.

Vanilla only: Treaty Coordination - T2 | 800 credits | 180 s cooldown

For 20 seconds, powered Relays provide damage +15% instead of +10%. No additional benefit outside their fields.

Superweapon / Aurora Microwave Array

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 7 min recharge | 8 s warning

A microwave burst affects an 8-cell-radius zone. Enemy vehicles and aircraft lose weapons for 8 seconds; powered enemy structures shut down for 18 seconds. Vehicles can still move, aircraft do not crash, and infantry remain operational. Direct damage is light.

Counterplay. Disperse powered infrastructure, advance with infantry, and retreat disabled vehicles. Destroying Aurora during its warning cancels the pulse.

On the battlefield

Opening. Establish one contested position with Jagers and Leopards; add Radar, a Relay and Rapiers. Use artillery to make opponents enter the network rather than chasing blindly.

Fight this faction. Attack the network edges, disable power, force repeated repositioning and use cheap units to absorb slow precision volleys.

02.1 / NEC SUBFACTION

Nordics / Northern Watch

Norway, Sweden, Denmark and Finland pooled maritime surveillance and dispersed defense commands after repeated failures of centralized dispatch. Northern Watch treats early warning as a public service and prefers to lose ground briefly rather than lose the soldiers needed to retake it.

Doctrine. Reconnaissance, mobile missiles and coastal denial.

Modifiers. Scout and artillery sight +20%. Amphibious vehicle movement speed +15% on land and water. Tank health -10%.

Unique units and losses

Fen Recon Carrier (F / T1) replaces Surveyor APC. Amphibious detector and transport. Can deploy a 6-cell sensor mast, becoming immobile and visibly exposed.

Fjord Missile Carrier (F / T2) replaces Archer SPG. Amphibious precision missile artillery; fast redeployment, long reload and little splash.

Removed without replacement. Argent Rail Tank.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Jager Squad; Spike Team	Fen Recon Carrier; Leopard Tank	-	Skerry Patrol Boat
T2	Sapper	Rapier AA; Fjord Missile Carrier	Kestrel Interceptor	Horizon Escort
T3	-	-	Aster EW Aircraft	Concord Monitor

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Relay remains at T2. Lance Rail Emplacement and Aurora Microwave Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Sensor Fusion (T2); Distributed Control (T3).

Exclusive research: Dispersed Links. T2 | 1,000 credits. Deployed Fen masts provide the Relay damage bonus in 4 cells using onboard power. Fields work during base power loss, do not stack with Relays and do not gain Relay radius upgrades.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Survey Drone (T2); Counterbattery Mission (T3).

New third power: Silent Watch. T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown. Friendly stationary ground units in a 6-cell-radius area camouflage for up to 15 seconds. Movement, firing or detection breaks concealment.

Replaces vanilla-only Treaty Coordination. Superweapon: Aurora is unchanged. Exploit the shutdown to reposition missile carriers rather than attempting a heavy frontal breakthrough. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use Fen carriers to reveal attack routes and screen mobile artillery with infantry and Rapiers.

Counterplay. Close distance under smoke or cover, bring detectors, and force fights where thin armor cannot disengage.

02.2 / NEC SUBFACTION

Eurocorps / Franco-German Armored Directorate

France and Germany sponsor the largest shared manufacturing program in the Confederation. Eurocorps sees common equipment and professional command as the antidote to political fragmentation. Its critics see procurement policy turning into a claim to lead every coalition operation.

Doctrine. Expensive armored formations and siege breakthroughs.

Modifiers. Tank health +15%. Tank cost +10%. All land combat vehicle build time +10%.

Unique units and losses

Marte Heavy MBT (F / T2) replaces Leopard Tank. Heavy medium-tank replacement with good frontal protection and slow acceleration. Requires Radar, delaying the first tank.

Charlemagne Siege Tank (F / T3) replaces Argent Rail Tank. Deploys in 4 seconds to gain weapon range +25%. Cannot turn its hull or move while deployed; weak against infantry.

Removed without replacement. Aster EW Aircraft.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Jager Squad; Spike Team	Surveyor APC	-	Skerry Patrol Boat
T2	Sapper	Marte Heavy MBT; Rapier AA; Archer SPG	Kestrel Interceptor	Horizon Escort
T3	-	Charlemagne Siege Tank	-	Concord Monitor

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Relay remains at T2. Lance Rail Emplacement and Aurora Microwave Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Sensor Fusion (T2); Distributed Control (T3).

Exclusive research: Shared Fire Solutions. T3 | 1,700 credits. Marte and Charlemagne gain reload interval -10% inside a powered Relay field.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Survey Drone (T2); Counterbattery Mission (T3).

New third power: Armored Overwatch. T2 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown. For 15 seconds, stationary tanks in a selected 6-cell-radius zone gain weapon range +10%. Moving immediately removes the bonus.

Replaces vanilla-only Treaty Coordination. Superweapon: Aurora is unchanged. Time the shutdown with the slow advance and deployment of the siege line. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Defend with infantry and Surveyors until Radar unlocks Marte; add Relays before building a costly siege group.

Counterplay. Punish the delayed tank timing, flank deployed guns and force this expensive army to defend several places.

02.3 / NEC SUBFACTION

Alpine Brotherhood / Pass and Tunnel Compact

Austria, Switzerland and Italy formed mutual rescue and engineering associations to keep mountain passes, reservoirs and tunnel networks usable. The Brotherhood grew from these civic oaths into a military compact. Its loyalties run first to protected communities, sometimes at the expense of confederal strategy.

Doctrine. Fortified infantry, compact artillery positions and repairable defenses.

Modifiers. Combat infantry health +15%. Defensive structure cost -15%. Aircraft build time +20%.

Unique units and losses

Alpine Pioneer (B / T2) replaces Sapper. Builds one temporary infantry shelter per squad and repairs friendly defenses. A shelter lasts 45 seconds and grants occupants 25% bullet-damage resistance.

Ibex Crawler Gun (F / T2) replaces Archer SPG. Compact tracked howitzer with a 2-second deployment and strong frontal protection. Less range than Archer, vulnerable from behind.

Removed without replacement. Concord Monitor.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Jager Squad; Spike Team	Surveyor APC; Leopard Tank	-	Skerry Patrol Boat
T2	Alpine Pioneer	Rapier AA; Ibex Crawler Gun	Kestrel Interceptor	Horizon Escort
T3	-	Argent Rail Tank	Aster EW Aircraft	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Relay remains at T2. Lance Rail Emplacement and Aurora Microwave Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Sensor Fusion (T2); Distributed Control (T3).

Exclusive research: Tunnel Workshops. T2 | 1,000 credits. Engineers and Alpine Pioneers repair defensive structures 25% faster; credit cost per health restored is unchanged.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Survey Drone (T2); Counterbattery Mission (T3).

New third power: Emergency Earthworks. T2 | 700 credits | 180 s cooldown. Friendly infantry and defenses in a 5-cell-radius zone take 20% less explosive damage for 15 seconds. Does not protect vehicles.

Replaces vanilla-only Treaty Coordination. Superweapon: Aurora is unchanged. Use the interruption to advance pioneers and establish the next defensive position. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Hold a narrow front with Pioneers, Ibex guns and Rapiers; expand behind the line rather than investing everything in one fortress.

Counterplay. Out-expand the compact army, use long-range siege and avoid feeding infantry into prepared cover.

03 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

Order of the Levant and Mediterranean

Keep the wells. Keep the word.

Desalination operators, Levantine municipal councils and Mediterranean convoy leagues created an oath-bound order to defend water and energy infrastructure during the Blackout. Membership is civic and includes many faiths and secular communities. The Order now protects a chain of coastal enclaves rather than a continuous empire. It argues that no distant government should be able to shut off another city's water. Its solar directorates nevertheless want exclusive custody of the very Meridian controls that would make such coercion possible.

Visual direction. Ivory, copper and deep teal; heat shields, fabric screens and articulated wheels.

Combat infantry and light land vehicles: movement speed +10%, health -10%.

Generators produce +25% power; this creates no credits.

Strengths: rapid repositioning, screening and energy-intensive systems. Weaknesses: fragile screens and poor prolonged frontal trades.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Wayfarer Guard	B / T1	Mobile general infantry with modest protection.
Needle Team	B / T1	Anti-vehicle missile infantry; little anti-infantry damage.
Mirage Observer	B / T2	Unarmed detector and artillery spotter; camouflages after 6 stationary seconds.
Caravan APC	F / T1	Light transport, scout and detector; designed for rapid withdrawal.
Sirocco Tank	F / T1	Fast medium tank; less armor than conventional rivals.
Crescent AA	F / T2	Mobile anti-air missile system and detector.
Sandglass Mortar	F / T2	Light indirect artillery with a short deployment delay and limited range.
Sunlance Beam Tank	F / T3	Focused thermal beam damages a single target over time; vulnerable during sustained firing.
Shrike Interceptor	A / T2	Fast air-superiority fighter with limited endurance.
Nightjar Strike Drone	A / T3	Unmanned precision attacker; one anti-vehicle missile salvo before rearm.
Corsair Patrol Boat	D / T1	Fast coastal scout and anti-infantry gunboat.
Lantern Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Beacon Missile Ship	D / T3	Long-range missile siege ship; weak at close range.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

03 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

OLM / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Sunwall Projector and Helios Reflector

Advanced defense: Sunwall Projector. Continuous thermal anti-vehicle beam; excellent against slow targets, poor against infantry swarms.

Shared upgrades

Thermal Shrouds - T2 | 900 credits

Light land vehicles gain sight +10% and take 10% less thermal-beam damage.

Optical Mesh - T3 | 1,500 credits

Caravan APCs and their replacements camouflage after 6 seconds stationary without attacking. Moving or firing reveals them.

Support powers

Dust Screen - T2 | 400 credits | 90 s cooldown

A 6-cell-radius smoke zone lasts 12 seconds. All ground units inside, friendly or enemy, take 30% less direct-fire weapon damage; artillery and area blasts are unaffected.

Mobile Workshop - T3 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown

Place a visible, destructible repair drone station on clear ground. It repairs friendly vehicles in 5 cells at 2% maximum health per second for 15 seconds; no stacking.

Vanilla only: Open Corridor - T2 | 650 credits | 150 s cooldown

Friendly land vehicles in a selected 6-cell-radius zone gain movement speed +25% for 12 seconds. Units must be in the zone when activated.

Superweapon / Helios Reflector

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 8 min recharge | 10 s warning

A surviving orbital mirror focuses sunlight along a player-selected line 16 cells long and 3 cells wide. The beam traverses the line over 12 seconds, damaging ground units, ships and structures with strong thermal damage. It cannot track units after the line is committed.

Counterplay. Leave the marked line, attack along its flanks, and spread structures. Beam-resistant upgrades reduce its damage; smoke does not.

On the battlefield

Opening. Use Caravan and Sirocco groups to threaten several routes, screen retreats with Dust Screen, and bring Observers before attempting a siege.

Fight this faction. Keep a mobile reserve, force close fights, detect concealed observers and attack the thin frontline before energy weapons can concentrate.

03.1 / OLM SUBFACTION

Saudi Arabia / Solar Directorate

The Directorate operates vast solar farms, storage fields and desalination plants rebuilt after the Blackout. Its technocrats insist that dependable power requires unified command. Water councils accuse them of turning an emergency engineering mandate into a permanent monopoly.

Doctrine. Energy weapons and power-efficient late-game positions.

Modifiers. Generator output +20% relative to the parent faction. Thermal-beam weapon damage +15%. Land combat vehicle movement speed -10%.

Unique units and losses

Dawn Laser AA (F / T2) replaces Crescent AA. Detector with a continuous anti-air laser. Reliable against small drones, weaker against heavily armored aircraft; no ground attack.

Ifrit Prism Tank (F / T3) replaces Sunlance Beam Tank. Deploys in 3 seconds to focus a stronger anti-structure beam. Must remain stationary and maintain line of sight; no bouncing beams.

Removed without replacement. Beacon Missile Ship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Wayfarer Guard; Needle Team	Caravan APC; Sirocco Tank	-	Corsair Patrol Boat
T2	Mirage Observer	Dawn Laser AA; Sandglass Mortar	Shrike Interceptor	Lantern Escort
T3	-	Ifrit Prism Tank	Nightjar Strike Drone	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Sunwall Projector and Helios Reflector remain at T3.

Inherited research. Thermal Shrouds (T2); Optical Mesh (T3).

Exclusive research: Thermal Reservoirs. T3 | 1,500 credits. Ifrit and Dawn units gain reload or cooling interval -10%; does not alter Helios.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Dust Screen (T2); Mobile Workshop (T3).

New third power: Capacitor Discharge. T2 | 800 credits | 180 s cooldown. Thermal-beam units and Sunwall defenses in a 6-cell-radius zone deal damage +20% for 10 seconds, then cannot fire for 4 seconds while cooling. Replaces vanilla-only Open Corridor. Superweapon: Helios receives the thermal-beam damage modifier, but not unit-only cooling upgrades. Its warning and area are unchanged. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Build a conventional screen, then Dawn AA and Ifrits. Keep enough mobile Siroccos to prevent opponents bypassing the beam line.

Counterplay. Attack from multiple angles, use smoke against direct-fire units, and exploit the cooling period after Capacitor Discharge.

03.2 / OLM SUBFACTION

Algeria / Saharan Corridor Guard

The Corridor Guard began as a federation of railway crews, oasis councils and convoy escorts linking coast and interior. Its commanders distrust static borders and defend movement itself as the basis of political independence. They support the Order while resisting solar-directorate control of transit routes.

Doctrine. Fast light vehicles, ambushes and harassment.

Modifiers. Light land vehicle cost -15%. Light land vehicle build time -15%. Light land vehicle health -10%. Tank cost +15%.

Unique units and losses

Dune Rover (F / T1) replaces Caravan APC. Fast light transport and detector. Camouflages after 6 seconds without firing even while moving, but detection or taking damage reveals it for 6 seconds.

Scorpion Rocket Buggy (F / T2) replaces Sandglass Mortar. Light artillery vehicle firing a short rocket salvo before a long reload; no deployment delay, fragile chassis.

Removed without replacement. Sunlance Beam Tank.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Wayfarer Guard; Needle Team	Dune Rover; Sirocco Tank	-	Corsair Patrol Boat
T2	Mirage Observer	Crescent AA; Scorpion Rocket Buggy	Shrike Interceptor	Lantern Escort
T3	-	-	Nightjar Strike Drone	Beacon Missile Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Sunwall Projector and Helios Reflector remain at T3.

Inherited research. Thermal Shrouds (T2); Optical Mesh (T3).

Exclusive research: Distributed Fuel Caches. T2 | 900 credits. Dune Rovers and Scorpions gain movement speed +10% after 6 seconds out of combat; firing or taking damage ends it.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Dust Screen (T2); Mobile Workshop (T3).

New third power: False Convoy. T2 | 500 credits | 120 s cooldown. Create four visible decoy light vehicles for 25 seconds at a scouted clear location. They have 1 health, no damage, no collision and no capture ability; detectors identify them.

Replaces vanilla-only Open Corridor. Superweapon: Helios is unchanged. It supplies the heavy base-breaking pressure missing from the light-vehicle roster. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Raid collectors with Rovers and Needle passengers. Use Scorpions for repeated short attacks rather than prolonged firing lines.

Counterplay. Escort harvesters with detectors, hold mobile AA nearby and use fast splash-damage units to deny escape routes.

03.3 / OLM SUBFACTION

El-Andalus / Western Straits Compact

El-Andalus is a future Spanish coastal compact whose name deliberately invokes a layered regional past, rather than a religious conquest or a claim over present-day Spain. Port municipalities joined the Order after eastern power links failed. Its assemblies demand open shipping and local autonomy, often challenging the Order's more centralized directorates.

Doctrine. Port defense, durable escorts and infantry holding power.

Modifiers. Ship health +15%. Garrisoned combat infantry weapon damage +20%. Aircraft cost +15%.

Unique units and losses

Gate Guard (B / T1) replaces Wayfarer Guard. Shield-equipped infantry taking 25% less frontal bullet damage. Slower than Wayfarers; shields do not stop blasts or attacks from behind.

Strait Frigate (D / T2) replaces Lantern Escort. Detector and anti-air/anti-submarine escort with stronger short-range surface guns, at the cost of slower movement.

Removed without replacement. Sunlance Beam Tank.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Gate Guard; Needle Team	Caravan APC; Sirocco Tank	-	Corsair Patrol Boat
T2	Mirage Observer	Crescent AA; Sandglass Mortar	Shrike Interceptor	Strait Frigate
T3	-	-	Nightjar Strike Drone	Beacon Missile Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Sunwall Projector and Helios Reflector remain at T3.

Inherited research. Thermal Shrouds (T2); Optical Mesh (T3).

Exclusive research: Harbor Militia. T2 | 1,000 credits. Gate Guards gain damage +10% within 6 cells of a friendly Factory or Dock; no stacking between buildings.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Dust Screen (T2); Mobile Workshop (T3).

New third power: Straits Crossfire. T2 | 800 credits | 180 s cooldown. Friendly infantry and ships in a selected 6-cell-radius zone gain weapon range +10% and sight +20% for 15 seconds.

Replaces vanilla-only Open Corridor. Superweapon: Helios is unchanged. Use its fixed line to force enemies away from a defended crossing or coastal approach. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Secure buildings with Gate Guards, then combine Siroccos and Sandglass mortars. On water maps, add escort groups before expensive siege ships.

Counterplay. Attack outside garrison coverage, use indirect fire and overwhelm the compact army before it can protect several approaches.

04 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

Democratic Eurasian Federation

A thousand districts. One supply line.

The Federation emerged from emergency congresses linking surviving Russian regions, Kazakh transport authorities and the northern Korean industrial state. Its charter distributes representation among territorial and workplace assemblies, but wartime production quotas give the central supply ministry enormous power. Some districts defend the federation as their only protection from abandonment; others call its elections ceremonial. It wants Meridian reopened as a shared industrial backbone and is willing to occupy reluctant junction cities to make the plan function.

Visual direction. Oxide red, gray and pale yellow; slab armor, exposed running gear and standardized containers.

Land combat vehicles: cost -10%, build time -10%, movement speed -10%.

No free units, permanent production multiplier or unlimited passive income; numerical superiority still needs collectors and factories.

Strengths: replacement capacity, heavy artillery and sustained pressure. Weaknesses: slow reactions, supply exposure and cumbersome late-game formations.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Line Conscript	B / T1	Inexpensive rifle infantry; poor at independent assaults.
Recoil Team	B / T1	Unguided anti-vehicle weapon with useful close-range damage.
Signal Officer	B / T2	Detector; nearby infantry recover from suppression 50% faster within 5 cells.
Mule APC	F / T1	Light transport and detector; robust but slow.
Hammer Tank	F / T1	Mass-produced medium tank with modest sight.
Porcupine AA	F / T2	Dual-purpose flak against aircraft and light infantry; also a detector.
Anvil Rocket Battery	F / T2	Wide-area indirect barrage; inaccurate against isolated moving targets.
Colossus Siege Tank	F / T3	Slow heavy assault gun with strong area damage and poor traverse.
Kite Interceptor	A / T2	Simple air-superiority fighter; limited ground utility.
Burya Bomber	A / T3	Conventional area-bombing aircraft; visible and vulnerable on approach.
Picket Boat	D / T1	Cheap patrol craft with a heavy machine gun.
Rampart Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Boreal Missile Submarine	D / T3	Concealed missile submarine; surfaces for 8 seconds to bombard the coast, exposing itself to ordinary weapons.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

04 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

DEF / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Citadel Mortar and Perun Missile Complex

Advanced defense: Citadel Mortar. Armored indirect-fire defense; minimum range makes it vulnerable to close attacks.

Shared upgrades

Standardized Parts - T2 | 900 credits

Engineer repairs to land vehicles cost 15% fewer credits per health restored; applies anywhere, not only near a Factory.

Coordinated Barrages - T3 | 1,600 credits

Anvil batteries, Colossus tanks and their replacements gain reload interval -10% when stationary for at least 4 seconds. Moving resets the bonus.

Support powers

Mobilization Order - T2 | 700 credits | 180 s cooldown

For 20 seconds, Barracks and Factory production progresses 25% faster. Costs remain unchanged; benefit applies only while this power is active.

Tremor Barrage - T3 | 1,300 credits | 210 s cooldown

After a 6-second warning, four waves of conventional shells strike a 5-cell-radius area over 8 seconds. High area pressure, limited precision.

Vanilla only: Redundant Orders - T2 | 650 credits | 180 s cooldown

Friendly vehicles in a 6-cell-radius zone ignore weapon-disabling EMP effects for 10 seconds. Does not protect buildings or prevent damage.

Superweapon / Perun Missile Complex

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 8 min recharge | 10 s warning

One conventional bunker-buster missile detonates in a 3-cell-radius core, followed by a lower-damage fragmentation ring out to 7 cells. The core threatens heavy structures; the ring punishes tightly packed support units. It leaves no permanent contamination.

Counterplay. Move away from the central marker, separate production buildings and intercept the attack by destroying the launch complex during its warning. Normal AA cannot stop the strategic missile.

On the battlefield

Opening. Use cheap Hammers and infantry to contest two fronts, establish the economy behind them, then build a screened Anvil line rather than rushing one expensive capstone.

Fight this faction. Attack collectors, force artillery to redeploy, strike several fronts and avoid engaging the entire production stream head-on.

04.1 / DEF SUBFACTION

Russia / Northern Arsenal Command

The northern arsenal regions rebuilt around armored factories and winterized transport hubs. Their delegates promise that industrial self-sufficiency will prevent another collapse. The army's demand for predictable supply repeatedly clashes with local assemblies over how much civilian recovery can be postponed.

Doctrine. Slow armored assaults with active protection.

Modifiers. Land combat vehicle health +15%. Land combat vehicle cost +10%. Land combat vehicle movement speed -10%.

Unique units and losses

Ural Assault Tank (F / T2) replaces Hammer Tank. Heavy tank intercepting one incoming ordinary missile every 12 seconds. Cannot intercept shells, beams or superweapons; requires Radar.

Bear Siege Crawler (F / T3) replaces Colossus Siege Tank. Very slow assault platform with frontal armor and a heavy demolition cannon. Poor vision and weak rear protection.

Removed without replacement. Burya Bomber.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Line Conscript; Recoil Team	Mule APC	-	Picket Boat
T2	Signal Officer	Ural Assault Tank; Porcupine AA; Anvil Rocket Battery	Kite Interceptor	Rampart Escort
T3	-	Bear Siege Crawler	-	Boreal Missile Submarine

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Citadel Mortar and Perun Missile Complex remain at T3.

Inherited research. Standardized Parts (T2); Coordinated Barrages (T3).

Exclusive research: Layered Protection. T3 | 1,500 credits. Ural missile-interception cooldown falls from 12 to 9 seconds; Bear gains one such interceptor.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Mobilization Order (T2); Tremor Barrage (T3).

New third power: Steel Advance. T2 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown. Land vehicles in a 6-cell-radius zone take 20% less weapon damage for 12 seconds, but movement speed is reduced by a further 20% during the effect.

Replaces vanilla-only Redundant Orders. Superweapon: Perun is unchanged. Use it to remove a strongpoint before committing slow armor. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Screen with infantry and Mules until Radar; build a compact Ural spearhead supported by Porcupines and artillery.

Counterplay. Raid around the spearhead, use guns or beams that bypass missile interception, and strike weak rear armor.

04.2 / DEF SUBFACTION

Kazakhstan / Steppe Transit Command

Railway cities and open-country logistics authorities formed Transit Command to keep east-west movement from becoming a hostage of any one capital. Its troops favor dispersed depots and short engagements. Within the Federation, it is the loudest voice against concentrating every reserve in a few enormous arsenals.

Doctrine. Fast reconnaissance and mobile missile warfare.

Modifiers. Ground combat unit movement speed +20%. Refinery build cost -15%; collectors are not discounted. Land combat vehicle health -15%.

Unique units and losses

Steppe Recon Carrier (F / T1) replaces Mule APC. Fast light transport and detector with extended sight, but poor armor.

Saker Missile Truck (F / T2) replaces Anvil Rocket Battery. Precision anti-vehicle and anti-structure missile artillery; deploys in 1 second, with little splash.

Removed without replacement. Colossus Siege Tank.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Line Conscript; Recoil Team	Steppe Recon Carrier; Hammer Tank	-	Picket Boat
T2	Signal Officer	Porcupine AA; Saker Missile Truck	Kite Interceptor	Rampart Escort
T3	-	-	Burya Bomber	Boreal Missile Submarine

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Citadel Mortar and Perun Missile Complex remain at T3.

Inherited research. Standardized Parts (T2); Coordinated Barrages (T3).

Exclusive research: Mobile Dispatch. T2 | 900 credits. Steppe Carriers and Saker trucks gain sight +15% and pack up without delay after firing.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Mobilization Order (T2); Tremor Barrage (T3).

New third power: Transit Priority. T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown. Friendly collectors and ground transports in a 7-cell-radius zone gain movement speed +35% for 15 seconds. Does not improve harvesting or unloading rate.

Replaces vanilla-only Redundant Orders. Superweapon: Perun is unchanged. Recon carriers provide targeting for the heavy strike absent from the regular mobile roster. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Scout aggressively, establish a second collection route and use Sakers to strike valuable units before withdrawing.

Counterplay. Use fast attackers and aircraft, deny retreat routes and punish the thin armor whenever it stops to fire.

04.3 / DEF SUBFACTION

North Korea / Fortress Reconstruction Bureau

Following the Blackout, competing military and industrial councils reorganized the northern Korean state around hardened local districts. The Bureau joined the Federation for fuel and machine tools while retaining strict internal controls. Its engineers excel at redundancy and deception; its civilians bear the cost of reconstruction plans written as permanent mobilization.

Doctrine. Durable infantry, prepared positions and decoys.

Modifiers. Combat infantry health +20%. Combat infantry build time -15%. Defensive structure cost -10%. Aircraft cost +25%.

Unique units and losses

Fortress Guard (B / T1) replaces Line Conscript. Rifle squad that deploys in 3 seconds for stronger suppressive fire; cannot move while deployed.

Echo Team (B / T2) replaces Signal Officer. Detector and suppression-recovery support. Can place one non-blocking decoy tank per team every 40 seconds; decoy lasts 30 seconds and has 1 health.

Removed without replacement. Boreal Missile Submarine.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Fortress Guard; Recoil Team	Mule APC; Hammer Tank	-	Picket Boat
T2	Echo Team	Porcupine AA; Anvil Rocket Battery	Kite Interceptor	Rampart Escort
T3	-	Colossus Siege Tank	Burya Bomber	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Citadel Mortar and Perun Missile Complex remain at T3.

Inherited research. Standardized Parts (T2); Coordinated Barrages (T3).

Exclusive research: Buried Command Lines. T2 | 1,000 credits. Radar and defensive structures recover from EMP shutdown 25% sooner; does not prevent initial shutdown.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Mobilization Order (T2); Tremor Barrage (T3).

New third power: False Front. T2 | 500 credits | 150 s cooldown. Place a 30-second decoy Radar and three decoy tanks in a scouted 6-cell zone. All are harmless, non-blocking and revealed by detectors.

Replaces vanilla-only Redundant Orders. Superweapon: Perun is unchanged. Decoys conceal preparations; they never hide or falsify the real superweapon countdown. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Build overlapping infantry positions and a modest Hammer reserve, using decoys to make the location of the real artillery line uncertain.

Counterplay. Verify targets with detectors, attack the economy outside fortified districts and use sustained siege rather than chasing decoys.

05 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

Pacific Dominion

The sea connects us.

Australia, Indonesian maritime leagues and Japanese industrial authorities kept each other alive through a chain of protected shipping routes. Their emergency maritime command became the Pacific Dominion: a treaty government whose authority is strongest at sea and contested on land. Its admirals want Meridian reopened without allowing a continental power to dictate access to ports. Smaller islands increasingly ask whether the Dominion's promise of open passage includes the right to refuse its bases.

Visual direction. Ocean blue, coral orange and white; sealed hulls, folding flight surfaces and deck-mounted drones.

Collectors are amphibious and can cross navigable water at 70% of their land speed. They still collect only from designated deposits and unload at a Refinery.

Ships gain movement speed +15%.

Defensive structures have health -15%. Strengths: alternative routes and mobile staging. Weaknesses: vulnerable fixed positions and costly losses during landings.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Ranger Marine	B / T1	General infantry optimized for fighting after transport deployment.
Harpoon Team	B / T1	Anti-vehicle missile infantry; may target surface ships, never aircraft.
Reef Technician	B / T2	Unarmed specialist repairing nearby land vehicles or ships, one target at a time.
Wake Skimmer	F / T1	Amphibious light transport and detector.
Tide Tank	F / T1	Amphibious medium tank; slow movement on water.
Storm AA	F / T2	Land-based anti-air and detector; requires a transport to cross water.
Breaker Howitzer	F / T2	Conventional land artillery with good sustained fire.
Leviathan Assault Carrier	F / T3	Heavy amphibious vehicle with a short-range siege cannon and infantry capacity.
Petrel Fighter	A / T2	Dedicated interceptor with good patrol endurance.
Osprey Strike Tiltrotor	A / T3	Anti-vehicle attack aircraft that hovers when firing; vulnerable to focused AA.
Reef Patrol Boat	D / T1	Fast coastal scout and light-surface attacker.
Trident Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Tempest Carrier	D / T3	Launches short-range strike drones against ground or surface targets; needs escort protection.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

05 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

PD / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Sea Spear Battery and Tempest Swarm Hub

Advanced defense: Sea Spear Battery. Long-range missile defense targeting ground vehicles or ships, but not aircraft; vulnerable during reload.

Shared upgrades

Expeditionary Maintenance - T2 | 1,000 credits

Reef Technicians repair 25% faster. Repair credit cost per health restored is unchanged.

Integrated Flight Decks - T3 | 1,600 credits

Airfield rearm time -15%; carrier drone replacement time -15%. Applies to carrier replacements.

Support powers

Maritime Patrol - T2 | 500 credits | 90 s cooldown

A shootable patrol aircraft reveals and detects a 20-cell-long, 6-cell-wide corridor for 12 seconds. Works over land and water.

Expeditionary Workshop - T3 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown

A shootable aircraft drops a 20-second workshop on clear land or water, repairing friendly vehicles and ships in 5 cells at 1.5% maximum health per second.

Vanilla only: Joint Landing - T2 | 700 credits | 180 s cooldown

For 15 seconds, friendly ground units that disembark from transports take 20% less weapon damage for 6 seconds. Reboarding cannot refresh an existing protection effect.

Superweapon / Tempest Swarm Hub

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 8 min recharge | 10 s warning

Launches 24 autonomous strike drones toward a selected 6-cell-radius area. They attack ground and surface targets there for up to 20 seconds before their batteries expire. Drones are individually targetable by AA and their approach direction is visible. Maximum aggregate damage is high, but interception can sharply reduce it.

Counterplay. Concentrate overlapping AA near the marked zone, move mobile units out, or destroy the hub during the warning. Drones cannot capture, scout beyond their attack zone or be salvaged.

On the battlefield

Opening. Use Wake Skimmers and Tide Tanks to threaten routes that conventional armies cannot cover cheaply; build enough Storm AA to protect the landing area before investing in a fleet.

Fight this faction. Guard landing exits, attack weak static defenses and keep aircraft ready to strike isolated amphibious columns.

05.1 / PD SUBFACTION

Australia / Southern Reach Command

Remote settlements and long supply lines taught Southern Reach to value information and range over dense occupation. It supports the Dominion as a safeguard for trade, but resists proposals to turn every maritime dispute into a permanent continental deployment.

Doctrine. Long-range expeditionary artillery backed by reconnaissance aircraft.

Modifiers. Land artillery weapon range +15%. Airfield construction time -15%. Land combat vehicle health -10%. Ship build time +15%.

Unique units and losses

Outrider Howitzer (F / T2) replaces Breaker Howitzer. Long-range mobile artillery with a narrow firing arc and 3-second deployment; weak at close range.

Wedge Recon Fighter (A / T2) replaces Petrel Fighter. Detector-equipped fighter with extended sight; lower anti-air damage than Petrel.

Removed without replacement. Leviathan Assault Carrier.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Ranger Marine; Harpoon Team	Wake Skimmer; Tide Tank	-	Reef Patrol Boat
T2	Reef Technician	Storm AA; Outrider Howitzer	Wedge Recon Fighter	Trident Escort
T3	-	-	Osprey Strike Tiltrotor	Tempest Carrier

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Sea Spear Battery and Tempest Swarm Hub remain at T3.

Inherited research. Expeditionary Maintenance (T2); Integrated Flight Decks (T3).

Exclusive research: Forward Fire Control. T3 | 1,500 credits. Outriders gain reload interval -10% while their target is within 6 cells of a friendly Wedge Recon Fighter.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Maritime Patrol (T2); Expeditionary Workshop (T3).

New third power: Long Watch. T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown. Reveal a 7-cell-radius area for 18 seconds through a high-altitude sensor pass. It reveals terrain and ordinary units but does not detect camouflage.

Replaces vanilla-only Joint Landing. Superweapon: Tempest Swarm is unchanged. Use it to force a defended enemy position to split attention between the air and artillery. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Build a compact marine and Tide screen, then Wedge reconnaissance and Outrider batteries. Relocate as soon as the firing line is exposed.

Counterplay. Rush the artillery, contest reconnaissance aircraft and use raids to stretch a small expeditionary screen.

05.2 / PD SUBFACTION

Indonesia / Archipelago Defense League

Island governments joined their patrol fleets and rescue services to keep local routes open when distant command centers failed. The League supplies much of the Dominion's landing infantry and insists that maritime security must answer to the communities living beside the ports.

Doctrine. Transport assaults, inexpensive marines and raids across several routes.

Modifiers. Combat infantry build time -15%. Transport health +20%, including Landing Transports. Tank cost +15%.

Unique units and losses

Kancil Landing Skimmer (F / T1) replaces Wake Skimmer. Fast amphibious light transport and detector. Passengers unload 50% faster; its weapon is weaker than Wake's.

Island Raider (B / T1) replaces Ranger Marine. Mobile rifle infantry gaining weapon damage +20% for 6 seconds after disembarking. The effect cannot be refreshed by immediate reboarding.

Removed without replacement. Tempest Carrier.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Island Raider; Harpoon Team	Kancil Landing Skimmer; Tide Tank	-	Reef Patrol Boat
T2	Reef Technician	Storm AA; Breaker Howitzer	Petrel Fighter	Trident Escort
T3	-	Leviathan Assault Carrier	Osprey Strike Tiltrotor	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Sea Spear Battery and Tempest Swarm Hub remain at T3.

Inherited research. Expeditionary Maintenance (T2); Integrated Flight Decks (T3).

Exclusive research: Distributed Beachheads. T2 | 1,000 credits. Reef Technicians gain movement speed +15% and can repair a transport while riding in it, one Technician per transport.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Maritime Patrol (T2); Expeditionary Workshop (T3).

New third power: Feint Landing. T2 | 500 credits | 120 s cooldown. Create three harmless, non-blocking decoy transports for 25 seconds on scouted land or water. They cannot carry units and are identified by detectors.

Replaces vanilla-only Joint Landing. Superweapon: The Tempest Swarm Hub remains available despite losing the Tempest Carrier; they are separate technologies. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Move Raiders in several Kancils, force defenders to commit to one approach, then land elsewhere. Use normal artillery for sustained land siege.

Counterplay. Scout the real transports, use area damage at unloading points and force Raiders to fight after their arrival bonus expires.

05.3 / PD SUBFACTION

Japan / Maritime Systems Authority

Industrial cities and shipyard administrations rebuilt Japan's defense around automation because skilled crews were scarce after the Blackout. The Authority treats precise, limited operations as a way to preserve lives. Its reliance on remote systems has widened the political distance between those authorizing force and those living under it.

Doctrine. Expensive precision systems, adaptable armor and advanced carriers.

Modifiers. Aircraft and ship reload intervals -10%; Airfield rearm time is unchanged. All combat unit cost +10%. Defensive structure health -10%.

Unique units and losses

Shinano Adaptive Tank (F / T2) replaces Tide Tank. Amphibious tank switching in 3 seconds between mobile direct fire and stationary long-range siege fire. Siege mode loses anti-infantry effectiveness.

Shogun Drone Carrier (D / T3) replaces Tempest Carrier. Advanced carrier switching between surface-strike drones and interceptor drones; only one wing type may operate at a time.

Removed without replacement. Breaker Howitzer.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Ranger Marine; Harpoon Team	Wake Skimmer	-	Reef Patrol Boat
T2	Reef Technician	Shinano Adaptive Tank; Storm AA	Petrel Fighter	Trident Escort
T3	-	Leviathan Assault Carrier	Osprey Strike Tiltrotor	Shogun Drone Carrier

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Sea Spear Battery and Tempest Swarm Hub remain at T3.

Inherited research. Expeditionary Maintenance (T2); Integrated Flight Decks (T3).

Exclusive research: Predictive Maintenance. T3 | 1,700 credits. Shinano mode changes take 2 seconds; Shogun drone replacement time -20%.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Maritime Patrol (T2); Expeditionary Workshop (T3).

New third power: Precision Window. T2 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown. Friendly aircraft and ships in a 6-cell-radius zone gain weapon damage +20% for 10 seconds, but receive no bonus to sight or survivability.

Replaces vanilla-only Joint Landing. Superweapon: Tempest Swarm is unchanged; combat-unit cost and reload modifiers do not apply to temporary superweapon drones. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use infantry and Skimmers until Radar unlocks Shinanos. On land, their siege mode replaces the lost howitzer; at sea, build one well-escorted Shogun.

Counterplay. Exploit the delayed tank timing, force expensive units to split and attack while carriers change wing types.

06 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

Han Empire

A common future requires a common plan.

A post-Blackout restoration movement recast the surviving Chinese central government as the Han Empire, claiming an old dynastic name for a new administrative order. In this setting the title is political, not a claim that its citizens share one ethnicity. Vietnamese and Cambodian successor governments joined through unequal security and infrastructure treaties, retaining their own armed commands. The imperial court promises to end scarcity by coordinating Meridian centrally; its provincial partners disagree sharply over who gets to write the plan.

Visual direction. Jade green, crimson and porcelain; compact modular hulls, sensor crowns and standardized drone racks.

Combat infantry cost -15% and build time -15%.

Land combat vehicle health -10%.

A Link Operator or Dragon Command Walker grants friendly unmanned combat units within 5 cells weapon damage +10%. Fields do not stack; destroying or suppressing the provider removes its field. Strengths: combined infantry/drone pressure; weaknesses: fragile vehicles and exposed control units.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Banner Infantry	B / T1	Inexpensive general infantry; needs supporting weapons against armor.
Lance Team	B / T1	Anti-vehicle rocket infantry with a long reload.
Link Operator	B / T2	Unarmed detector and provider of the 5-cell command field.
Jade Carrier	F / T1	Light transport and detector; vulnerable to direct tank fire.
Ox Tank	F / T1	Simple medium tank used to screen infantry formations.
Firefly AA Drone	F / T2	Unmanned mobile anti-air and detector; no useful anti-tank attack.
Nest Rocket Drone	F / T2	Unmanned indirect-fire launcher; fragile and dependent on spotting.
Dragon Command Walker	F / T3	Crewed heavy support vehicle with a cannon and 5-cell command field; expensive, large target.
Swallow Interceptor	A / T2	Unmanned air-superiority fighter; cannot attack ground targets.
Silkwing Drone Bomber	A / T3	Unmanned precision bomber with a slow rearm cycle.
Canal Patrol Boat	D / T1	Cheap coastal scout and infantry support craft.
Jade Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Emperor Drone Ship	D / T3	Crewed carrier launching unmanned surface-strike drones; weak at close range.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

06 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

HAN / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Dragon Tooth Launcher and Dragonfall Field Foundry

Advanced defense: Dragon Tooth Launcher. Short salvos of guided anti-vehicle missiles; powerful burst, vulnerable between salvos.

Shared upgrades

Resilient Mesh - T2 | 1,000 credits

Unmanned combat units recover from EMP weapon shutdown 25% sooner; they still take normal EMP damage.

Distributed Cognition - T3 | 1,700 credits

Command-field radius increases from 5 to 7 cells. Bonuses still do not stack and no unit is useful only inside a field.

Support powers

Wideband Scan - T2 | 400 credits | 90 s cooldown

Reveal and detect a 7-cell-radius area for 6 seconds. A visible scan warning gives opponents 2 seconds before detection begins.

Software Surge - T3 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown

Friendly unmanned combat units in a 6-cell-radius zone gain reload interval -25% for 12 seconds, then lose weapons for 3 seconds. Excludes superweapon summons.

Vanilla only: Reserve Bandwidth - T2 | 650 credits | 150 s cooldown

For 20 seconds, all surviving command-field providers gain radius +3 cells. Damage bonus stays at +10% and overlapping fields still do not stack.

Superweapon / Dragonfall Field Foundry

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 8 min recharge | 10 s warning

Three assembly capsules land within a marked 5-cell-radius area, then take 5 seconds to unfold into autonomous siege engines. They can be attacked during assembly. For 60 seconds after assembly they operate as slow anti-structure ground units, then their limited-energy cores expire. They cannot capture, repair, harvest, receive command-field buffs or generate salvage.

Counterplay. Attack capsules before assembly, surround the slow engines with anti-tank units, or retreat and wait out their 60-second lifetime. Destroying the Foundry during warning cancels deployment.

On the battlefield

Opening. Use cheap infantry to secure ground, add Ox tanks and Firefly AA, then support a Nest group with protected Link Operators.

Fight this faction. Use area damage against infantry, prioritize command providers, force vehicle trades and do not allow several drone systems to fire behind an intact screen.

06.1 / HAN SUBFACTION

China / Imperial Standards Army

The central Standards Army presents uniform equipment and reliable public works as proof of the restoration's legitimacy. Its armored commands protect the routes that bind imperial provinces together. Their officers are divided between rebuilding a useful state and enforcing the court's demand for obedience.

Doctrine. Heavy armor and stronger local command coverage.

Modifiers. Land combat vehicle health +15%. Land combat vehicle cost +10%. Combat infantry build time +10%.

Unique units and losses

Imperial Guard Tank (F / T2) replaces Ox Tank. Better-armored medium tank with an accurate anti-vehicle gun; requires Radar and remains weak against infantry masses.

Long Command Walker (F / T3) replaces Dragon Command Walker. Heavy crewed command platform. Deploying in 3 seconds extends its command radius by 2 cells but prevents movement.

Removed without replacement. Silkwing Drone Bomber.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Banner Infantry; Lance Team	Jade Carrier	-	Canal Patrol Boat
T2	Link Operator	Imperial Guard Tank; Firefly AA Drone; Nest Rocket Drone	Swallow Interceptor	Jade Escort
T3	-	Long Command Walker	-	Emperor Drone Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Dragon Tooth Launcher and Dragonfall Field Foundry remain at T3.

Inherited research. Resilient Mesh (T2); Distributed Cognition (T3).

Exclusive research: Guard Integration. T3 | 1,600 credits. Imperial Guard Tanks count as eligible recipients of command-field damage bonuses, despite being crewed.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Wideband Scan (T2); Software Surge (T3).

New third power: Central Priority. T2 | 800 credits | 180 s cooldown. For 15 seconds, command fields provide weapon damage +20% instead of +10%; their radius is unchanged.

Replaces vanilla-only Reserve Bandwidth. Superweapon: Dragonfall is unchanged. Temporary siege engines cannot benefit from Central Priority or Guard Integration. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use Banner and Lance infantry to survive until Radar, then combine Guard tanks with Fireflies, Nest drones and a command provider.

Counterplay. Attack before the first Guard tanks arrive, remove providers and use terrain to prevent the army concentrating its expensive core.

06.2 / HAN SUBFACTION

Vietnam / Canopy Defense Command

Vietnamese defense councils entered the imperial treaty system to secure reconstruction supplies while preserving operational autonomy. Canopy Command regards dispersed defense as insurance against both foreign invasion and imperial overreach. Its soldiers train for ambushes in any terrain, not only forests.

Doctrine. Concealed infantry and amphibious rocket raids.

Modifiers. Combat infantry movement speed +10%. Light land vehicle cost -10%. Tank cost +20%.

Unique units and losses

Canopy Ranger (B / T1) replaces Banner Infantry. Rifle infantry camouflaging after 6 seconds stationary without firing on any terrain. Moving, attacking or taking damage reveals it.

Reed Rocket Skimmer (F / T2) replaces Nest Rocket Drone. Unmanned amphibious light artillery firing short rocket bursts; less range and health than Nest.

Removed without replacement. Dragon Command Walker.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Canopy Ranger; Lance Team	Jade Carrier; Ox Tank	-	Canal Patrol Boat
T2	Link Operator	Firefly AA Drone; Reed Rocket Skimmer	Swallow Interceptor	Jade Escort
T3	-	-	Silkwing Drone Bomber	Emperor Drone Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Dragon Tooth Launcher and Dragonfall Field Foundry remain at T3.

Inherited research. Resilient Mesh (T2); Distributed Cognition (T3).

Exclusive research: Hidden Relays. T2 | 1,000 credits. Link Operators camouflage after 6 seconds stationary without attacking; their command field remains active while hidden.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Wideband Scan (T2); Software Surge (T3).

New third power: Broken Contact. T2 | 650 credits | 150 s cooldown. Ground combat units in a 6-cell-radius zone gain movement speed +20% for 10 seconds and leave a 6-second smoke screen at their initial position. Smoke follows the shared Dust Screen rule.

Replaces vanilla-only Reserve Bandwidth. Superweapon: Dragonfall remains available despite losing the Dragon Command Walker; it is an independent strategic structure. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Threaten several approaches with Rangers; bring Link Operators and Reed skimmers to turn an ambush into a short, concentrated barrage.

Counterplay. Use detectors and persistent scouting, keep units spread against rockets and pressure the faction when it cannot safely reset concealment.

06.3 / HAN SUBFACTION

Cambodia / Mekong Reconstruction Authority

The Authority grew from river engineers, agricultural cooperatives and urban repair teams. It accepted imperial backing to rebuild transport and irrigation, then developed its own field robotics to reduce dependence on imported crews. Its leadership balances material gains against the fear that every new connection also tightens political control.

Doctrine. Drone sustain, field repair and economical support systems.

Modifiers. Unmanned combat unit cost -15%. Repairs to friendly structures progress 25% faster; cost per health is unchanged. Tank build time +20%.

Unique units and losses

Lotus Drone Tender (F / T1) replaces Jade Carrier. Light transport and detector. Repairs one nearby friendly unmanned land unit at 1% maximum health per second, paying normal repair cost; cannot repair itself.

Mekong Field Engineer (B / T2) replaces Link Operator. Unarmed detector, structure repairer and command provider. Its command field requires a 2-second stationary deployment; service Engineers remain available.

Removed without replacement. Emperor Drone Ship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Banner Infantry; Lance Team	Lotus Drone Tender; Ox Tank	-	Canal Patrol Boat
T2	Mekong Field Engineer	Firefly AA Drone; Nest Rocket Drone	Swallow Interceptor	Jade Escort
T3	-	Dragon Command Walker	Silkwing Drone Bomber	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Dragon Tooth Launcher and Dragonfall Field Foundry remain at T3.

Inherited research. Resilient Mesh (T2); Distributed Cognition (T3).

Exclusive research: Modular Servicing. T3 | 1,500 credits. Lotus Tenders repair 50% faster, but credit cost per health restored is unchanged.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Wideband Scan (T2); Software Surge (T3).

New third power: Repair Swarm. T2 | 700 credits | 180 s cooldown. Repair friendly unmanned land units and structures in a 5-cell-radius zone by 2% maximum health per second for 10 seconds. This paid power has no further repair charge.

Replaces vanilla-only Reserve Bandwidth. Superweapon: Dragonfall is unchanged. Its temporary engines cannot be repaired by Lotus Tenders, Engineers or Repair Swarm. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use infantry to shield Fireflies and Nest drones, keeping a few Lotus Tenders behind the line. Avoid trading support vehicles for a short-lived damage advantage.

Counterplay. Focus one target at a time, kill Tenders and deployed engineers, and prevent the army withdrawing to repair.

07 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

African Empire

What survives belongs to the future.

Nigerian commercial and civic alliances, a Kongo basin compact and southern industrial states built a reconstruction federation around power corridors and mutual investment. Its elected High Steward adopted the title Emperor after mediating a succession of near-civil wars, turning a temporary compromise into a disputed constitutional institution. This Empire claims no automatic authority over all Africa. It wants to own the machinery of recovery rather than purchase access from outsiders, but debates over corridor revenues and the Steward's emergency powers threaten its cohesion.

Visual direction. Ochre, charcoal and bright cyan; repairable panels, reinforced wheels and interchangeable weapon modules.

Service Engineers and Reclaimers may salvage destroyed enemy land combat vehicles: an 8-second uninterrupted action yields 20% of the unit's paid purchase cost. Each wreck pays once; allied, self-destroyed, decoy and temporary summoned units produce no income.

Land-vehicle repairs cost 25% fewer credits per health restored.

Land artillery weapon range -10%. Strengths: sustained ground campaigns and economic recovery after winning battles. Weaknesses: must hold the battlefield to salvage, and can be outranged.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Union Guard	B / T1	Reliable general infantry protecting repair and salvage teams.
Pike Team	B / T1	Anti-tank infantry with a short-to-medium-range missile.
Reclaimer	B / T2	Armed salvage specialist; repairs one land vehicle at normal Engineer rate and gains salvage access.
Mamba APC	F / T1	Wheeled light transport and detector; strong road mobility.
Buffalo Tank	F / T1	Conventional medium tank designed for repair and reuse.
Weaver AA	F / T2	Mobile anti-air and detector with poor anti-armor capability.
Forge Howitzer	F / T2	Durable indirect artillery with shorter range than most rivals.
Kiln Assault Crawler	F / T3	Heavy demolition vehicle with a broad blast and short reach.
Sunbird Interceptor	A / T2	Dedicated fighter protecting advancing ground formations.
Hammerhead Gunship	A / T3	Close-support anti-vehicle aircraft, vulnerable to prepared AA.
Delta Patrol Boat	D / T1	River and coastal scout with a light cannon.
Anchor Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Sovereign Arsenal Ship	D / T3	Heavy naval artillery platform with limited mobility.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

07 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

AE / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Forge Cannon and Horizon Mass Driver

Advanced defense: Forge Cannon. Armored rapid-cycling anti-vehicle turret; shorter range than rail defenses.

Shared upgrades

Recovery Winches - T2 | 900 credits

Salvage actions take 5 rather than 8 seconds. Wreck value is unchanged.

Circular Armor - T3 | 1,600 credits

Land combat vehicles gain health +10%. Does not create salvage from friendly losses or increase a wreck's paid-cost basis.

Support powers

Survey Network - T2 | 400 credits | 90 s cooldown

Reveal a 7-cell-radius area for 12 seconds and highlight salvageable wrecks there. Reveals ordinary units but does not detect camouflage.

Field Refurbishment - T3 | 1,000 credits | 180 s cooldown

Repair friendly land vehicles in a 6-cell-radius zone by 3% maximum health per second for 10 seconds. They cannot fire while receiving repairs; moving ends repair on that unit.

Vanilla only: Recovery Priority - T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown

For 20 seconds, Engineers and Reclaimers gain movement speed +25% and salvage in 3 seconds. Salvage payout is unchanged.

Superweapon / Horizon Mass Driver

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 8 min recharge | 10 s warning

A rail-assisted strategic battery strikes three overlapping circles, each 3 cells in radius, along a 10-cell line over 9 seconds. Impacts damage ground units, ships and structures. On land, pulverized debris slows all land vehicles by 35% for 20 seconds and prevents new construction there; it never blocks movement or permanently changes the map.

Counterplay. Leave the marked line before the first impact, avoid routing reinforcements through the debris, and attack from the sides. Existing buildings remain usable if they survive.

On the battlefield

Opening. Use Buffalo tanks and infantry to win a local fight, secure the area, then bring salvage teams. Spend recovered credits on expansion before attempting an expensive siege push.

Fight this faction. Disengage before losing vehicles, deny wreck fields with artillery and use air attacks to bypass the repaired frontline.

07.1 / AE SUBFACTION

Nigeria / Civic Logistics Directorate

Metropolitan councils, inland trade unions and communications firms formed the Directorate to prevent recovery funds disappearing into regional patronage. Its army combines rapidly organized infantry with field communications and drone support. Political rivals accuse it of mistaking the interests of its largest cities for those of the whole Empire.

Doctrine. Fast mobilization, infantry presence and protective drone support.

Modifiers. Combat infantry cost -15%. Combat infantry build time -15%. Non-superweapon structure construction time -10%. Aircraft health -10%.

Unique units and losses

Civic Rifle Team (B / T1) replaces Union Guard. Rifle infantry able to place one 20-second sensor puck every 30 seconds. Puck reveals a 4-cell area but does not detect camouflage and is destructible.

Lagos Drone Guard (F / T2) replaces Weaver AA. Mobile anti-air and detector with one small repair drone. The drone repairs one nearby infantry unit at 1% maximum health per second and can be shot down.

Removed without replacement. Kiln Assault Crawler.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Civic Rifle Team; Pike Team	Mamba APC; Buffalo Tank	-	Delta Patrol Boat
T2	Reclaimer	Lagos Drone Guard; Forge Howitzer	Sunbird Interceptor	Anchor Escort
T3	-	-	Hammerhead Gunship	Sovereign Arsenal Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Forge Cannon and Horizon Mass Driver remain at T3.

Inherited research. Recovery Winches (T2); Circular Armor (T3).

Exclusive research: Municipal Reserves. T2 | 1,000 credits. Civic Rifle Teams gain health +10% within 6 cells of a friendly Barracks or Refinery; fields do not stack.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Survey Network (T2); Field Refurbishment (T3).

New third power: Civil Defense Net. T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown. Friendly infantry in a 6-cell-radius area gain sight +25% and suppression immunity for 15 seconds.

Replaces vanilla-only Recovery Priority. Superweapon: Horizon is unchanged; the structure construction bonus does not shorten its build time or recharge. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Secure several points with Civic teams, support them with Lagos vehicles and Buffalo tanks, and use superior presence to protect collectors and wreck fields.

Counterplay. Use mobile area damage, destroy exposed support drones and force infantry to leave the infrastructure that strengthens them.

07.2 / AE SUBFACTION

Kongo / River Compact Guard

Kongo here names a fictional multi-state Congo Basin compact, not a claim that today's countries have merged. River councils and conservation authorities built its institutions around navigable routes, reservoirs and protected catchments. The Guard supports imperial industry but resists extraction that destroys the infrastructure and communities it is meant to serve.

Doctrine. Amphibious transport, durable infantry and concealed recovery teams.

Modifiers. Amphibious vehicle movement speed +20% on land and water. Combat infantry health +10%. Land artillery cost +20%.

Unique units and losses

Okapi Amphibious Carrier (F / T1) replaces Mamba APC. Amphibious light transport and detector; thin armor but strong passenger capacity.

River Warden (B / T2) replaces Reclaimer. Armed repair and salvage infantry. Camouflages after 6 seconds stationary; repairing, salvaging or firing reveals it.

Removed without replacement. Sovereign Arsenal Ship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Union Guard; Pike Team	Okapi Amphibious Carrier; Buffalo Tank	-	Delta Patrol Boat
T2	River Warden	Weaver AA; Forge Howitzer	Sunbird Interceptor	Anchor Escort
T3	-	Kiln Assault Crawler	Hammerhead Gunship	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Forge Cannon and Horizon Mass Driver remain at T3.

Inherited research. Recovery Winches (T2); Circular Armor (T3).

Exclusive research: Watershed Logistics. T2 | 1,000 credits. Okapi carriers repair carried infantry at 1% maximum health per second after 6 seconds out of combat; free healing does not repair the carrier.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Survey Network (T2); Field Refurbishment (T3).

New third power: Concealed Crossing. T2 | 600 credits | 150 s cooldown. Lay a 16-cell-long, 4-cell-wide smoke corridor on land or water for 12 seconds. It follows the shared Dust Screen damage rule and protects either side.

Replaces vanilla-only Recovery Priority. Superweapon: Horizon is unchanged. Its slowing debris can protect a retreat, but also slows friendly vehicles. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Move Wardens and infantry in Okapis, attack vulnerable resource routes, and retreat damaged vehicles behind the infantry screen for repair.

Counterplay. Watch alternative crossings, reveal Wardens with detectors and use long-range artillery to deny safe recovery positions.

07.3 / AE SUBFACTION

South Africa / Southern Arsenal Union

The Union links manufacturing cities, research institutions and organized labor under a common reconstruction charter. It supplies much of the Empire's precision machinery and insists that technical independence must include domestic control of design and production. Its influence grows with every weapon sold to its partners.

Doctrine. Long-range ground weapons and expensive precision vehicles.

Modifiers. Land combat vehicle weapon range +10%. Land combat vehicle cost +15%. Combat infantry build time +15%.

Unique units and losses

Rhino Rail Tank (F / T2) replaces Buffalo Tank. Accurate anti-armor rail tank with little splash; requires Radar and cannot efficiently clear infantry alone.

Protea Gun Carrier (F / T2) replaces Forge Howitzer. Switches in 3 seconds between indirect siege shells and short-range defensive canister fire; cannot use both simultaneously.

Removed without replacement. Hammerhead Gunship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Union Guard; Pike Team	Mamba APC	-	Delta Patrol Boat
T2	Reclaimer	Rhino Rail Tank; Weaver AA; Protea Gun Carrier	Sunbird Interceptor	Anchor Escort
T3	-	Kiln Assault Crawler	-	Sovereign Arsenal Ship

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Forge Cannon and Horizon Mass Driver remain at T3.

Inherited research. Recovery Winches (T2); Circular Armor (T3).

Exclusive research: Precision Machining. T3 | 1,700 credits. Rhino and Protea reload intervals -10%; applies in either Protea firing mode.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Survey Network (T2); Field Refurbishment (T3).

New third power: Counterbattery Solution. T2 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown. Reveal enemy artillery that fired during the preceding 8 seconds within a selected 9-cell area, then mark those units for 12 seconds. Friendly ground weapons deal +15% damage to marked targets.

Replaces vanilla-only Recovery Priority. Superweapon: Horizon is unchanged. Unit-range upgrades never increase the strategic weapon's map reach. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use infantry and Mambas until Radar, then establish overlapping Rhino and Protea firing lines. Keep enough AA to protect a ground-focused force.

Counterplay. Pressure before Radar, use infantry swarms and flanking attacks, and force expensive guns to keep changing firing modes.

08 / VANILLA / DOCTRINE AND ROSTER

South Asian Protectorate

No refuge left undefended.

After successive grid failures and displacement crises, Indian, Pakistani and Thai successor authorities negotiated a mutual-protection compact for power, food and evacuation routes. Thailand belongs through maritime and infrastructure treaties, not through a claim that it is geographically South Asian. The Protectorate was meant to expire when civilian systems recovered. Its military council now argues that only permanent joint guardianship can prevent another catastrophe, while reformers demand the return of emergency powers to local governments.

Visual direction. Sand, indigo and saffron; layered armor, deployable braces and prominent interception sensors.

Defensive structures gain health +15%.

Power reserve: defenses keep operating for 20 seconds after a power shortage begins. Reserve recharges only after 60 continuous seconds of adequate power. EMP-disabled defenses remain disabled; superweapons never use this reserve.

Land combat vehicles move 10% slower. Strengths: protected positions and measured advances. Weaknesses: slow map response and the temptation to overspend on fortifications.

Complete combat technology tree

Unit	Unlock	Role
Shield Rifle Squad	B / T1	General infantry with good staying power behind cover.
Kavach Team	B / T1	Anti-vehicle missile infantry; cannot fire on the move.
Combat Pioneer	B / T2	Armed engineer building temporary cover and repairing defenses; cannot capture structures.
Jackal APC	F / T1	Light transport and detector with modest armor.
Bulwark Tank	F / T1	Slow medium tank supporting infantry advances.
Vajra AA	F / T2	Dedicated mobile anti-air and detector.
Monsoon Howitzer	F / T2	Steady indirect artillery with a 3-second deployment.
Elephant Siege Tank	F / T3	Heavy assault gun with strong anti-structure damage and slow traverse.
Garuda Interceptor	A / T2	Dedicated defensive fighter with good endurance.
Sarus Gunship	A / T3	Close-support anti-vehicle aircraft with a short effective range.
Estuary Patrol Boat	D / T1	River and coastal scout with a light cannon.
Shield Escort	D / T2	Anti-air, anti-submarine escort and detector.
Citadel Monitor	D / T3	Armored coastal artillery ship, slow and vulnerable without escorts.

B Barracks / F Factory / A Airfield / D Dock. T2 adds Radar; T3 adds Radar + Laboratory. All shared service units and structures also remain available.

08 / VANILLA / RESEARCH AND COMMAND

SAP / Advanced systems

Building path. Headquarters -> Generator -> Refinery -> Factory -> Radar -> Laboratory; Generator -> Barracks | Refinery -> Dock | Radar -> Airfield; Radar + Laboratory -> Bastion Missile Tower and Trident Interception Array

Advanced defense: Bastion Missile Tower. Durable anti-vehicle missile defense with strong burst damage and a long reload; no anti-air attack.

Shared upgrades

Layered Fieldworks - T2 | 1,000 credits

Combat infantry within 4 cells of a friendly defensive structure take 10% less explosive damage; overlapping structures do not stack.

Reserve Capacitors - T3 | 1,600 credits

Defense power reserve increases from 20 to 35 seconds. Recharge still requires 60 continuous seconds of adequate power.

Support powers

Recon Balloon - T2 | 450 credits | 90 s cooldown

Deploy a shootable tethered observation drone at a clear location for 20 seconds. It reveals terrain and detects within 6 cells.

Emergency Fortification - T3 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown

Friendly defenses and production buildings in a 6-cell-radius zone take 25% less weapon damage for 15 seconds. Does not protect the superweapon structure or prevent EMP.

Vanilla only: Protected Advance - T2 | 750 credits | 180 s cooldown

For 12 seconds, infantry and land vehicles in a selected 6-cell-radius zone take 15% less weapon damage. Units receive no movement bonus.

Superweapon / Trident Interception Array

Radar + Laboratory | 5,000 credits | 200 power | 6 min recharge | 6 s warning

Protects a selected 6-cell-radius zone for 25 seconds with 24 interception charges. Each incoming hostile ordinary missile or artillery shell crossing the boundary consumes one charge and is destroyed. A superweapon impact packet consumes 8 charges to reduce its damage by 50%, never to cancel it. Beams, bullets, EMP, units entering the zone and weapons fired from inside it bypass interception. The zone is fixed and clearly visible.

Counterplay. Exhaust charges with cheap projectiles, attack with beams or infantry, enter the zone, or wait 25 seconds. Protection can support an offensive push; it is not a permanent base shield.

On the battlefield

Opening. Establish an economical infantry and Bulwark screen, protect the first expansion with a small defense cluster, then move the army forward with artillery rather than staying in the starting base.

Fight this faction. Expand around the slow army, bait the interception zone away from the real target, use attacks from inside its boundary and punish excessive static defense spending.

08.1 / SAP SUBFACTION

India / Integrated Defense Command

The largest Protectorate member rebuilt joint logistics across a patchwork of surviving state institutions. Integrated Defense Command wants military compatibility to make mutual protection credible. Its size also makes neighboring partners wary that integration could become another word for dependence.

Doctrine. Heavy protected pushes supported by economical power infrastructure.

Modifiers. Land combat vehicle health +15%. Land combat vehicle build time +15%. Generator cost -10%.

Unique units and losses

Arjun Assault Tank (F / T2) replaces Bulwark Tank. Armored medium tank mounting a short-range active-protection system. It intercepts one ordinary missile every 15 seconds; requires Radar.

Gaj Siege Platform (F / T3) replaces Elephant Siege Tank. Heavy siege vehicle that deploys in 4 seconds for weapon range +20% and cannot move while deployed.

Removed without replacement. Sarus Gunship.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Shield Rifle Squad; Kavach Team	Jackal APC	-	Estuary Patrol Boat
T2	Combat Pioneer	Arjun Assault Tank; Vajra AA; Monsoon Howitzer	Garuda Interceptor	Shield Escort
T3	-	Gaj Siege Platform	-	Citadel Monitor

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Bastion Missile Tower and Trident Interception Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Layered Fieldworks (T2); Reserve Capacitors (T3).

Exclusive research: Integrated Protection. T3 | 1,700 credits. Arjun missile-interception cooldown falls from 15 to 10 seconds; Gaj gains one interceptor with the same cooldown.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Recon Balloon (T2); Emergency Fortification (T3).

New third power: Assault Coordination. T2 | 900 credits | 180 s cooldown. Friendly tanks in a 6-cell-radius zone gain reload interval -15% and sight +15% for 12 seconds.

Replaces vanilla-only Protected Advance. Superweapon: Trident is unchanged. Use it over the destination of an armored advance rather than always over the starting base. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Defend with infantry until Radar, then push with Arjuns, Vajras and Gaj platforms in stages, keeping a modest power surplus.

Counterplay. Exploit slow production, use non-missile anti-tank weapons and force repeated Gaj redeployment.

08.2 / SAP SUBFACTION

Thailand / River and Strait Command

Thai river authorities and maritime services joined the Protectorate to secure both inland food routes and access to the wider ocean. Their commanders favor flexible defense and evacuation over static prestige projects. They often mediate between the compact's continental powers while resisting demands to commit everything to their border disputes.

Doctrine. Amphibious infantry assaults and mobile defense.

Modifiers. Amphibious combat vehicle cost -15%. Combat infantry movement speed +10%. Defensive structure health -10%. Tank reload interval +10%.

Unique units and losses

Naga Amphibious Carrier (F / T1) replaces Jackal APC. Amphibious light transport and detector with a smoke launcher: one 4-cell-radius, 6-second shared-rule smoke screen every 40 seconds.

River Marine (B / T1) replaces Shield Rifle Squad. Rifle infantry taking 20% less weapon damage for 6 seconds after disembarking. Immediate reboarding cannot refresh the effect.

Removed without replacement. Elephant Siege Tank.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	River Marine; Kavach Team	Naga Amphibious Carrier; Bulwark Tank	-	Estuary Patrol Boat
T2	Combat Pioneer	Vajra AA; Monsoon Howitzer	Garuda Interceptor	Shield Escort
T3	-	-	Sarus Gunship	Citadel Monitor

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Bastion Missile Tower and Trident Interception Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Layered Fieldworks (T2); Reserve Capacitors (T3).

Exclusive research: Rapid Ferry Drills. T2 | 900 credits. Naga loading and unloading time -40%; does not change passenger attack speed.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Recon Balloon (T2); Emergency Fortification (T3).

New third power: Mobile Reserve. T2 | 650 credits | 150 s cooldown. Friendly ground transports in a 7-cell-radius zone gain movement speed +30% for 15 seconds and may unload while moving at half speed.

Replaces vanilla-only Protected Advance. Superweapon: Trident is unchanged. The zone can cover either end of a crossing, but not both if they lie outside its radius. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Use Nagas to relocate infantry rapidly, keep Monsoon guns behind the landing area, and defend several approaches with a mobile reserve.

Counterplay. Attack after disembarkation protection expires, control crossing exits and use heavy armor against the lighter assault groups.

08.3 / SAP SUBFACTION

Pakistan / Frontier Observation Command

Frontier Observation Command arose from early-warning services and reconstruction troops protecting long, exposed corridors. It supports mutual protection but demands safeguards against domination by larger partners. Its doctrine emphasizes finding an attack early and disrupting it before a costly close battle begins.

Doctrine. Long-range missile artillery and concealed forward observation.

Modifiers. Land artillery weapon range +15%. Ordinary guided-missile flight speed +20%; excludes superweapons. Light land vehicle health -15%.

Unique units and losses

Shaheen Missile Battery (F / T2) replaces Monsoon Howitzer. Precision missile artillery requiring 3 seconds to deploy; long reach, small blast radius and vulnerable during reload.

Watchpost Recon Team (B / T2) replaces Combat Pioneer. Detector and artillery observer that camouflages after 6 stationary seconds. Cannot build cover or repair defenses.

Removed without replacement. Citadel Monitor.

Complete combat technology tree

Tier	Barracks	Factory	Airfield	Dock
T1	Shield Rifle Squad; Kavach Team	Jackal APC; Bulwark Tank	-	Estuary Patrol Boat
T2	Watchpost Recon Team	Vajra AA; Shaheen Missile Battery	Garuda Interceptor	Shield Escort
T3	-	Elephant Siege Tank	Sarus Gunship	-

T1: producer. T2: producer + Radar. T3: producer + Radar + Laboratory. All shared structures and four service units remain. Bastion Missile Tower and Trident Interception Array remain at T3.

Inherited research. Layered Fieldworks (T2); Reserve Capacitors (T3).

Exclusive research: Observer Network. T3 | 1,500 credits. Shaheen batteries gain reload interval -10% when their target is within 6 cells of a Watchpost team.

Command powers and superweapon

Inherited powers. Recon Balloon (T2); Emergency Fortification (T3).

New third power: Counterlaunch Plot. T2 | 800 credits | 180 s cooldown. Mark enemy artillery that fired in the last 8 seconds inside a selected 8-cell-radius zone. After a 5-second warning, conventional shells hit the marked positions, not the units' new locations.

Replaces vanilla-only Protected Advance. Superweapon: Trident is unchanged. Protect a missile battery during a decisive salvo, then relocate before the zone expires. Parent cost, charge and warning remain.

Opening. Scout with Jackals and Watchpost teams; protect Shaheens with Bulwarks and Vajras. Fire from unexpected angles rather than making one enormous gun line.

Counterplay. Hunt observers with detectors, use aircraft and fast vehicles, and move immediately after firing to evade Counterlaunch Plot.

APPENDIX A / POLITICS THAT CREATE MISSIONS

Campaign fault lines

North America / Europe

Both support international reconstruction, but disagree over military occupation versus binding civilian oversight. A shared relief operation can become a confrontation over who commands it.

Europe / Order

They need each other's ports and power exchanges. The conflict is whether water access can be guaranteed by treaty when solar plants remain under exclusive control.

Order / African Empire

Shared coastal trade encourages cooperation; rival corridor tariffs and control of desalination machinery create a practical, non-religious source of conflict.

Eurasia / Han Empire

Both seek coordinated industrial recovery, but each wants authority over the continental scheduling system. Border depots and railway junctions become bargaining chips.

Pacific / Han Empire

Shipping access and the political independence of treaty ports are the central dispute. Capturing a port is easy compared with persuading its residents to accept the winner.

Pacific / Protectorate

They can cooperate over evacuation routes yet clash over who inspects maritime cargo and where foreign bases may operate.

African Empire / Protectorate

They share an interest in independent reconstruction technology but compete over industrial contracts and access to eastern shipping corridors.

Every bloc / its own members

Each campaign should include one mission where following central orders damages the faction's stated purpose. Subfactions disagree over methods, resources and authority rather than existing only as cosmetic national teams.

APPENDIX B / PROTOTYPE PRIORITIES

From proposal to playable game

1. Prototype the eight vanilla rosters before adding all 24 variants. Give each faction a playable early anti-infantry unit, anti-tank answer, detector, mobile AA and siege route before tuning special mechanics.
2. Use three map families: open land, constrained urban routes, and mixed coast/river. Include at least two exits from each starting area; avoid mandatory water for baseline economic access.
3. Measure first scout, first tank, first mobile AA, first siege and first superweapon timings. A variant that moves its tank from T1 to T2 must survive with its actual T1 roster, not an assumed inherited tank.
4. Test equal-spend armies, then repeat with reinforcements, repairs and travel time. A nominally equal fight can still favor a faction that reaches the next battle earlier.
5. Track salvage credits as a share of total income. If African wins create an excessive snowball, reduce salvage payout before weakening every unit.
6. Measure damage escaped during superweapon warnings, Tempest losses to AA, Dragonfall assembly survival and Trident charges spent. All strategic weapons should create decisions for the defender.
7. Keep duplicate command fields, repair stations and decoy income disabled. Never let a replacement inherit both its old unit's special ability and its new ability unless explicitly stated.
8. Only after these tests, assign final unit costs, health, damage, armor classes, reloads and speed. The present document is a complete faction/technology proposal, not a verified competitive balance patch.

Suggested first playable slice

Use the North American Peace Corps and the Order as an initial contrast: durable conventional pressure versus mobile screening and energy weapons. Start with T1 and T2 ground combat, economy, scouting and one shared map. Add their vanilla powers, then USA and Algeria as the first specialization test. The rest of the bible remains the design target.

What is intentionally still open

Final unit prices and damage values, armor interaction tables, squad implementation, campaign protagonists, final country borders and a production-ready implementation. These require playtests or further worldbuilding; numerical precision here should not be mistaken for measured balance.